

Does School Matter?

A lot of people your age are quietly asking the same thing. If AI can answer anything, do you even need school anymore? Why sit through years of classes when the tool spits out the answer in seconds?

Think about it this way.

Fast forward a few years. You've landed your dream job at Google, and AI sits right next to you all day, cranking out drafts, code, and plans. Your coworker at the next desk is doing the same. You each have the same job, using the same AI.

Here's the catch: ask AI the same question, and it hands back the same answer, to you, your coworker, and everyone else. So what makes you more valuable? It's not the answer itself. **It's what you already know, which shapes the question you ask and what you do with the answer.**

WHAT MOST PEOPLE DO NOT UNDERSTAND

In the AI era, learning is more important than it's ever been. This seems counterintuitive, but it's true. This inspired the name of this course, **Be Smarter Than the Tool**. Whatever college and career you choose, the more you learn, the more successful you'll be.

In almost any job, you'll have AI as your partner. So, for your dream job at Google, here's what it looks like.

Two skills. Both grow with what you know.

AI gives everyone the same answer. These two skills are yours, and the more you learn, the better you get at both.

1

Ask the right question

What you know shapes what you ask. A sharper question gets a better answer, before AI does anything special.

2

Make the answer better

Read it, judge if it's right, push back, and make it better. AI can't do this for you, it doesn't know what you know.

Those two things are your domain. This is where you need to live. And it starts today, not when you work at Google. Double down on building your knowledge and skills. And one day you'll be the CEO at Google.



The difference is you. AI hands similar answers to anyone who asks a similar question. Asking a better question, and making the answer better, only happen if you know enough. That's why you learn.

TRY IT

Here are five answers AI gave, each one stated with total confidence, and each one with something wrong. The question isn't whether AI makes mistakes. It's whether what you've learned lets you catch them. For each, be honest: can you catch the mistake, or would you have to trust it?